



are partly due to a placebo effect, they are still worthwhile nonetheless!

Sleep

One of the best recovery methods you can incorporate into your life is optimising your sleep. Many people overlook sleep because it's a normal part of life, but they often fail to recognise its importance when it comes to recovery.

Research has shown that poor sleep leads to slower and less complete recovery from training and reduces pain tolerance by up to 15 per cent. On the other hand, getting more sleep has been shown to significantly improve athletic performance. The general recommendation is 7–9 hours of sleep per night. Sleep quality is of prime importance — not just lying in bed tossing and turning.

Tips to enhance sleep quality

- ✦ Stick to a consistent bedtime and wake-up time.
- ✦ Avoid caffeine within 6–8 hours of

bedtime.

- ✦ Limit alcohol intake at night.
- ✦ Turn off the TV and put away your phone well ahead of bedtime.
- ✦ Keep your room pitch dark.
- ✦ Ensure your room is cool and comfortable.

By following these tips, you'll enjoy a great night of uninterrupted sleep, helping you recover and feel refreshed each morning!

Nutrition

Training hard to become stronger and fitter is only half the battle; you also need to fuel your body appropriately. Unfortunately, many people put a great deal of effort into their training but just sort of hope for the best when it comes to their nutritional habits. This approach is an appetite for destruction.

It's a no-brainer that you need an adequate amount of calories to fuel your workouts, but nutrition goes far beyond calorie intake. Whether it's

Cold treatment: English goalkeeper Ellie Roebuck recovers in a cryotherapy chamber following a training session. Many studies have shown that power output and work capacity improve significantly when post-workout cryotherapy sessions are performed regularly. GETTY IMAGES

protein, carbohydrates, fats, minerals, trace elements, or even hydration, all play a crucial role in optimising your performance and recovery.

The quality of the food you eat matters too. For instance, if your goal is to build strength and muscle, you must consume sufficient high-quality protein to support muscle growth and recovery.

Equally important is ensuring you get the necessary vitamins and minerals. This is where eating a variety of fruits, vegetables, and whole, nutrient-dense foods becomes essential. Proper nutrition fuels proper performance throughout the season.